

Answers to Final Exam Questions (Sp23 & Sp24)

1. Makki and Madani Revelations (Sp23, Sp24)

Definition of Makki and Madani Surah

The most widely accepted opinion states that any Ayah or Surah revealed *before* the Hijrah (immigration) of the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) from Makkah to Madinah is considered Makki, regardless of the actual place of revelation. Conversely, any Ayah or Surah revealed *after* the Hijrah is considered Madani.

Characteristics of Makki and Madani Surahs

The division between Makki and Madani Surahs is generally based on their themes and internal evidence, as well as various reports. Here are some general characteristics:

Makki Surahs

- **Period of Revelation:** Revealed over approximately 12-13 years, from the first call to Islam until the Hijrah. Examples include Surah Al-Fatihah and Surah Al- ‘Alaq [Page 4].
- **Length:** Most Makki Surahs are shorter in length, such as Surah Al-Ikhlās (112) and Surah Al- ‘Asr (103) [Page 4].
- **Themes:** Primarily deal with fundamental beliefs like Tawheed (oneness of Allah), Resalah (Prophethood), and Akhirah (life hereafter), as well as good morals and conduct. They guide people to the oneness of Allah and the pillars of Iman. Examples include Surah Al-Fatihah, Al-Ikhlās, and Al-Ma ‘un [Page 4].
- **Content:** Often contain passages regarding previous Christian and Jewish scriptures and stories of past Prophets and Messengers (e.g., Surah Al-A`raf, Al-Anbiaa, Al-Qasas). They discuss the hereafter, heavens, hells, and disputations with non-believers (e.g., Surah Ya-Seen) [Page 4].
- **Addressing Style:** Frequently use general addresses like “O people” or “O Mankind” (Ya Aiiuhannas), inviting humanity towards belief, heaven, hell, and the Day of Judgment (e.g., Surah Al-Insan, Al-Jalalah, At-Takathur, Al- ‘Asr) [Page 4].

- **Linguistic Features:** Characterized by brief and short verses with strong wording (e.g., Surah Al-Fatihah, Al- ‘Asar, Al-Ikhlās, Al-Kauthar) [Page 4].
- **Specific Signs:** The word ‘Kalla’ is mentioned in 33 places, all in Makki Surahs. Many Makki Surahs contain oaths in Arabian tone (e.g., Surah At-Teen, Al-Buruj, At-Tarique, Al- ‘Asar). Most Surahs in the latter part of the Qur’ ān (Mufasssal group, 49-114) are Makki. Surahs 67-97 are all Makki. Masjid al-Aqsha is mentioned in a Makki Surah (Al-Isra). All Surahs named after Prophets (except Surah Muhammad) are Makki. The middle point of the Qur’ ān (Surah Al-Kahaf 18:19) is in a Makki Surah. All Surahs with Ayah of Sajdah (prostration) are Makki, with exceptions. Of the 29 Surahs beginning with Muqattaat (disconnected letters), 26 are Makki [Page 5].

Madani Surahs

- **Length:** Generally longer than Makki Surahs (e.g., Surah Al-Baqarah, Ale-`Imran, An-Nisa, Al-Maidah) [Page 4].
- **Themes:** Deal with practical aspects of living, including injunctions of Shariah law, such as laws relating to marriage, divorce, probate, and criminal sanctions. They discuss comprehensive 'Ibadah (worship), Mu'amalath (dealings), Hudud (punishment), Jihad, family policy, and Islamic law (e.g., Surah Al-Baqarah, Ale-`Imran, An-Nisa, Al-Maidah) [Page 4].
- **Social Context:** Discuss the new growing community of Muhajiroon (immigrants) and Ansar (helpers) (e.g., Surah At-Tawbah, An-Nur, Al-Ahjab, Al-Hashar). They also address Ahlul Kitab (people of the books) and call them to Islam (e.g., Surah Ale-`Imran, Al-Maidah, Al-Baiyanat) [Page 4].
- **Addressing Style:** Often begin with “O you who believe” (Ya Aiyuhallajina Aamanu) (e.g., Surah Al-Maidah, Al-Hujrat, Al-Mumtahina) or “O people of the Book” (e.g., Surah Ale-`Imran, Al-Maidah, Al-Baiyanat). They frequently refer to hypocrites (Munafique) and discuss their signs and dangers (e.g., Surah An-Nisa, Al-Anfal, At-Tawbah, Al-Munafiqun) [Page 5].
- **Specific Signs:** Surah At-Tawbah is the only Surah without Basmalah. The Basmalah is repeated in Surah An-Naml (a Madani Surah). The Arabic month Ramadan is mentioned in only one Madani Surah (Al-Baqarah). The words Muhazirun and Ansar are found in

Madani Surahs. The name of Muhammad (SAAS) is mentioned in four Madani Surahs. The name of a Sahabi (companion) is mentioned in a Madani Surah (Al-Ahjab). The name of Madinah is mentioned in five Madani Surahs. The word Ka'bah is mentioned in a Madani Surah (Al-Maidah). The word Allah is mentioned in each Ayah of Surah Al-Mujadalah (Madani). The word Arab is mentioned in ten Madani places. The word Masjid Al-Haram is mentioned in fifteen Madani places, with one exception [Page 6].

Why the Holy Qur'an was divided into Makki and Madani Surahs (Benefits of knowing Makki and Madani Revelations)

Knowing the chronology of the Surahs and verses, and thus their classification as Makki or Madani, offers several significant benefits:

1. **Understanding the Meaning and Explanation of Qur'an:** Knowledge of the time and circumstances of revelation helps in understanding the meaning and explanation of Qur'anic verses. The context of revelation often clarifies the implications of the verses [Page 6].
2. **Understanding the Position of Muslims in Makkah and Madinah:** It helps to understand the different stages of the Muslim community's development. Makki verses are particularly meaningful for Muslims living in un-Islamic environments, while Madani verses are relevant for communities in the process of forming an Islamic society [Page 6].
3. **Essential for Knowing Nasikh and Mansukh (Abrogation):** This knowledge is crucial for determining which legal rulings are obligatory when there are seemingly contradictory verses. The later revealed (Madani) verse can abrogate an earlier (Makki) one, but not vice-versa [Page 3, 6].
4. **Understanding Gradual Development of Muslim Society:** It allows for an understanding of the historical and gradual development of Muslim practices, attitudes, and laws, such as the prohibition of alcohol or the regulations concerning fighting. This provides insight into how these matters evolved during the Prophet's (SAAS) lifetime [Page 6].
5. **Identifying First and Last Revelations:** The knowledge of Makki and Madani revelations is essential for identifying the first and last revealed verses of the Qur'an

[Page 6].

6. **Trust in the Qur' an' s Preservation:** It reinforces trust in the Qur' an' s exact preservation, free from change and distortion, as scholars meticulously documented the context of each revelation [Page 6].
7. **Guidance for Interpretation:** It aids in the correct interpretation of the Qur' an, preventing misinterpretations and misunderstandings [Page 6].
8. **Understanding Prophetic Biography and Methodology:** It helps in understanding the Prophet Muhammad' s (SAAS) biography and his methods of guiding mankind in both the Makkan and Madinan periods, which can be applied in contemporary efforts to guide people [Page 6].
9. **Attention and Interest of Muslims in the Qur' an:** It highlights the immense care Muslims took in preserving not only the text but also the circumstances of its revelation, including time, place, and season [Page 6].
10. **Understanding Causes of Revelation (Asbabunnuzul):** It helps in knowing the specific causes or occasions for the revelation of particular Ayahs or Surahs [Page 7].

These characteristics and benefits underscore the importance of the Makki and Madani classification in the sciences of Qur'an (Ulum al-Qur'an) for a deeper and more accurate understanding of the Holy Book. [Page 7]

4. Miracles and Scientific Indications of the Holy Qur' an (Sp23, Sp24)

Definition of I' jaz al-Qur' an (Inimitability of the Holy Qur' an)

The term 'I' jaz' is derived from the Arabic root 'Ajaza', meaning to be incapable, to make powerless, to be impossible, or to be inimitable. In other words, I' jaz al-Qur' an refers to the inimitable and unique nature of the Holy Qur' an, which renders its opponents powerless or incapable of meeting the challenge it poses. It is considered the primary miracle of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) [Page 25].

What Constitutes a Miracle?

According to Muslim scholars, for an event to be accepted as a miracle from Allah, five correlations must be met:

1. **Divine Origin:** It must be an act that no one else, apart from Allah, the Master of the world, can perform.
2. **Breaks Norms:** It must break usual norms and differ from the laws of nature (not Allah's laws, but the way nature normally operates).
3. **Proof for Messenger:** It must serve as proof for the truth and claim of the Messenger.
4. **Happens by Messenger's Claim:** It must occur as a result of the Messenger's claim.
5. **Through Messenger Only:** The event must happen through the Messenger and no one else [Page 25].

Various Aspects of I'jaz al-Qur'an (Miraculous Nature of the Holy Qur'an)

The miraculous nature of the Holy Qur'an manifests in several aspects, making it the greatest and most enduring miracle:

1. Linguistic and Stylistic Inimitability (I'jaz al-Balaghi)

The Qur'an's linguistic perfection, eloquence, and unique literary style are unparalleled. It combines poetic beauty with profound meaning, a feat that no human has been able to replicate. The challenge posed by the Qur'an to produce a Surah like it remains unmet. Its structure, rhythm, and choice of words are divinely orchestrated, captivating both Arabs and non-Arabs alike. This aspect of I'jaz was particularly evident to the Arabs of the Prophet's time, who were masters of language and poetry, yet they were unable to produce anything comparable [Page 26].

2. Legislative Inimitability (I'jaz al-Tashri'i)

The Qur'an contains a comprehensive and perfect legal system that addresses all aspects of human life—social, economic, political, and spiritual. Its laws are just, equitable, and adaptable to all times and places. The balance it strikes between individual rights and communal responsibilities, and its emphasis on justice, mercy, and wisdom, demonstrate

its divine origin. The gradual prohibition of alcohol, as discussed in the lecture sheet, is an example of the Qur'ān's wise and practical legislative approach, adapting to human nature and societal conditions [Page 15].

3. Prophetic Inimitability (I'jaz al-Ghaybi)

The Qur'ān contains prophecies and predictions that have come true, such as the victory of the Romans over the Persians (Surah Ar-Rum) or the eventual triumph of Islam. These predictions, made at a time when their fulfillment seemed impossible, serve as clear evidence of the Qur'ān's divine source. The lecture sheet implicitly touches upon this by mentioning the Qur'an's role as a guide for all times and situations [Page 7].

4. Scientific Inimitability (I'jaz al-'Ilmi)

The Qur'ān contains numerous verses that allude to scientific facts and phenomena that were unknown at the time of its revelation and have only been discovered by modern science. These include descriptions of the embryonic development, the expansion of the universe, the water cycle, the functions of mountains, and the distinctness of fresh and salt waters. While the Qur'ān is not a science textbook, these scientific indications serve as compelling evidence of its divine authorship. Examples include:

- **Embryology:** Verses describing the stages of human embryonic development (e.g., Surah Al-Mu'minun 23:12-14) accurately depict processes discovered centuries later by modern embryology [Page 27].
- **Cosmology:** References to the creation of the universe from a gaseous mass (Surah Fussilat 41:11) and the expanding universe (Surah Adh-Dhariyat 51:47) align with modern astrophysical theories [Page 27].
- **Water Cycle:** The Qur'ān accurately describes the water cycle, including evaporation, cloud formation, and rainfall (e.g., Surah Az-Zumar 39:21, Surah An-Nur 24:43). These descriptions were far ahead of their time [Page 27].
- **Mountains:** The Qur'ān refers to mountains as “pegs” or “stabilizers” for the earth (Surah An-Naba 78:6-7), a concept consistent with modern geology, which understands mountains as having deep roots that stabilize the Earth's crust [Page 27].

- **Oceans:** The Qur’ān mentions a barrier between two bodies of flowing water, one fresh and sweet, and the other salty and bitter (Surah Al-Furqan 25:53). This phenomenon, known as a halocline, was only scientifically understood much later [Page 27].

5. Numerical Inimitability (I’jaz al-Adadi)

Some scholars have pointed to numerical patterns and repetitions of certain words in the Qur’ān as evidence of its miraculous nature. For example, the word “day” (yawm) appears 365 times, and “month” (shahr) appears 12 times, corresponding to the number of days in a year and months in a year, respectively. While this area is subject to ongoing research and interpretation, it adds another dimension to the Qur’ān’s unique composition [Page 28].

6. Psychological and Spiritual Inimitability

The Qur’ān has a profound impact on the human soul, inspiring faith, guiding conduct, and providing comfort and solace. Its verses resonate deeply with believers, transforming lives and fostering a sense of peace and purpose. The ability of the Qur’ān to motivate and unite diverse communities, and its enduring influence on individuals and societies, is a testament to its divine power [Page 28].

In conclusion, the Holy Qur’ān stands as a multifaceted miracle, encompassing linguistic brilliance, comprehensive legislation, accurate prophecies, scientific foresight, numerical precision, and profound spiritual impact. These various aspects collectively prove its divine origin and its status as the ultimate miracle of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). [Page 28]

5. Necessity and Importance of Hadith in Islamic Shari’ah (Sp23, Sp24)

Definition of Hadith

Literal Meaning: The word ‘Hadith’ literally means a piece of news, a story, a report, or a communication. It signifies something new, as opposed to something old [Page 34].

Terminological Meaning: In Islamic terminology, Hadith refers to the sayings, actions, approvals (tacit approvals), and descriptions of the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). It encompasses everything that is authentically reported from the Prophet (SAAS), whether it is a statement he made, an action he performed, an action or statement of others that he approved of, or a description of his physical or moral characteristics [Page 34].

Position and Importance of Hadith in Islamic Shari' ah

The Hadith holds a fundamental and indispensable position in Islamic Shari' ah (Islamic law). It is the second primary source of Islamic law after the Holy Qur' an. The importance of Hadith stems from its role in explaining, elaborating, and complementing the Qur' an. Without Hadith, many injunctions of the Qur' an would remain vague or impossible to implement. The Qur' an itself mandates obedience to the Prophet (SAAS), which implicitly includes following his Sunnah (way or practice), as preserved in Hadith [Page 34].

Here are the key reasons for the necessity and importance of Hadith:

1. **Explanation and Elaboration of the Qur' an:** The Qur' an often provides general principles and broad injunctions. The Hadith explains these principles in detail and provides practical guidance on how to implement them. For example, the Qur' an commands Muslims to establish prayer (Salat) and pay charity (Zakat), but it does not specify the number of prayers, their timings, the method of performing them, or the exact rates and conditions for Zakat. All these details are found in the Hadith. The Prophet (SAAS) said, “Pray as you have seen me praying,” and “Take your rituals of Hajj from me.” [Page 35]
2. **Clarification of Ambiguities:** Some verses in the Qur' an might appear ambiguous or open to multiple interpretations. The Hadith clarifies these ambiguities by providing the context of revelation (Asbab al-Nuzul) or by offering the Prophet' s (SAAS) own explanation. For instance, the Qur' an mentions “those who believe and do not mix their faith with injustice” (Surah Al-An' am 6:82). The companions understood “injustice” broadly, but the Prophet (SAAS) clarified that it refers specifically to Shirk (associating partners with Allah), citing Surah Luqman 31:13, “Indeed, Shirk is a great injustice.” [Page 35]
3. **Supplementing Qur' anic Laws:** The Hadith introduces certain laws and rulings that are not explicitly mentioned in the Qur' an. These are considered part of the divine

legislation, as the Prophet (SAAS) did not speak from his own desire but from divine inspiration. For example, the prohibition of combining a woman with her paternal or maternal aunt in marriage is established through Hadith, not directly from the Qur’ an. Similarly, the prohibition of eating the meat of domesticated donkeys or predatory animals with fangs is found in Hadith [Page 35].

- 4. **Abrogation (Naskh):** As discussed earlier, Hadith can sometimes abrogate certain Qur’ anic rulings or be abrogated by them, or abrogate other Hadith. This process is crucial for understanding the final and applicable rulings in Islamic law. The knowledge of Nasikh and Mansukh (abrogating and abrogated texts) is essential for proper legal derivation [Page 15].
- 5. **Understanding the Prophet’ s (SAAS) Character and Life (Sunnah):** The Hadith provides a comprehensive record of the Prophet’ s (SAAS) life, his moral character, his dealings with people, and his responses to various situations. This allows Muslims to emulate his exemplary conduct, as he is the perfect role model for humanity. The Qur’ an states, “Indeed in the Messenger of Allah you have a good example to follow” (Surah Al-Ahzab 33:21) [Page 35].
- 6. **Preservation of Islamic Identity:** The Hadith played a vital role in shaping the early Muslim community and continues to define Islamic identity. It provides the practical framework for Islamic rituals, ethics, and social norms, ensuring the continuity of the Prophetic tradition [Page 35].
- 7. **Basis for Ijtihad (Independent Legal Reasoning):** For Islamic scholars and jurists, Hadith is an indispensable tool for Ijtihad. When a new issue arises for which there is no direct ruling in the Qur’ an, scholars refer to the Hadith to derive a ruling based on the Prophet’ s (SAAS) teachings and precedents [Page 35].

Difference Between the Qur’ an and Hadith

While both the Qur’ an and Hadith are sources of Islamic law and divine guidance, there are fundamental differences between them:

Feature	Holy Qur’ an	Hadith

Nature	The literal word of Allah (Kalamullah), revealed to Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) through Angel Jibril. It is miraculous in its language and content.	Sayings, actions, and tacit approvals of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). It is divinely inspired but expressed in the Prophet's own words.
Revelation	Recited (Matlu) and preserved in its exact wording. Its recitation is an act of worship.	Not recited as part of formal worship (Salat). Its wording is not necessarily exact, but its meaning is preserved.
Authenticity	Unanimously agreed upon as entirely authentic and preserved without any alteration.	Authenticity is determined through rigorous chains of narration (Sanad) and textual analysis (Matan), leading to classifications like Sahih, Hasan, Da'if, etc.
Purpose	Primary source of Islamic law, providing fundamental beliefs, moral codes, and general principles.	Secondary source, explaining, elaborating, and supplementing the Qur'an; provides practical application of Islamic principles.
Challenge	Inimitable; no one can produce a chapter like it.	Not a challenge in the same way as the Qur'an's inimitability.
Transmission	Transmitted through continuous, mass transmission (Tawatur), ensuring its preservation.	Transmitted through various chains of narration, some reaching Tawatur, others being Ahad (single chain).

In conclusion, Hadith is an integral and essential component of Islamic Shari'ah. It serves as the practical embodiment of Qur'anic teachings, providing the necessary details and context for Muslims to live according to divine guidance. Its importance is repeatedly emphasized in the Qur'an itself, making it an indispensable source for understanding and practicing Islam. [Page 35]

6. Definition and Types of Hadith According to the Number of Reporters (Sp23, Sp24)

Definition of Hadith

As previously defined, the word ‘Hadith’ literally means a piece of news, a story, a report, or a communication. In Islamic terminology, Hadith refers to the sayings, actions, tacit approvals, and descriptions of the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). It encompasses everything authentically reported from him, whether it is a statement he made, an action he performed, an action or statement of others that he approved of, or a description of his physical or moral characteristics [Page 34].

Types of Hadith According to the Number of Reporters (Sanad)

Hadith are classified based on the number of reporters (narrators) involved in each stage of its chain of narration (Sanad). This classification is crucial for determining the authenticity and reliability of a Hadith. The main categories are Mutawatir and Ahad [Page 36].

1. Mutawatir Hadith

Definition: A Mutawatir Hadith is one that has been narrated by such a large number of narrators at each stage of the chain of narration that it is inconceivable for them to have conspired to fabricate a lie. This multitude of narrators ensures its absolute authenticity and reliability, making its content certain and undeniable [Page 36].

Conditions for Mutawatir Hadith:

- **Multiple Chains:** It must be narrated through numerous independent chains of narration.
- **Large Number of Narrators:** A sufficiently large number of narrators must exist at each stage of the chain, making collusion impossible. There is no universally agreed-upon minimum number, but it is generally understood to be more than three or four.
- **Direct Knowledge:** The narrators must have based their narration on direct sensory perception (e.g., they saw or heard it).

- **Consistency:** The narrations must be consistent in their meaning, even if the wording varies slightly.

Examples: The Qur'ān itself is considered Mutawatir in its transmission. Other examples include the number of daily prayers, the method of performing ablution (wudu), and the rituals of Hajj. These practices have been transmitted by so many people across generations that their authenticity is beyond doubt [Page 36].

Types of Mutawatir Hadith:

- **Mutawatir Lafzi (Verbal Mutawatir):** Where the exact wording of the Hadith is transmitted by a large number of narrators. This is rare.
- **Mutawatir Ma' nawi (Meaning-based Mutawatir):** Where the meaning or concept of the Hadith is transmitted by a large number of narrators, even if the exact wording differs. This is more common. For example, there are numerous Hadith about the Prophet (SAAS) raising his hands in supplication, but the exact wording of each Hadith may vary [Page 36].

2. Ahad Hadith

Definition: An Ahad Hadith is one that does not meet the conditions of a Mutawatir Hadith. It is narrated by a limited number of narrators at one or more stages of its chain. While Ahad Hadith may not provide absolute certainty like Mutawatir Hadith, they can still be authentic and reliable if their chain of narration is sound and their content is consistent with Islamic principles [Page 36].

Types of Ahad Hadith:

Ahad Hadith are further classified based on the number of narrators at each stage of the chain:

- **Mashhur (Well-Known):** A Hadith narrated by at least three narrators at every stage of the chain, but not reaching the number required for Mutawatir. It is widely known and accepted among scholars [Page 36].
- **Aziz (Rare/Strong):** A Hadith narrated by at least two narrators at every stage of the chain. It is less common than Mashhur but still considered strong [Page 36].

- **Gharib (Strange/Solitary):** A Hadith narrated by only one narrator at some stage of the chain. This type requires careful scrutiny, but if the single narrator is highly reliable, the Hadith can still be accepted [Page 36].

Importance of Ahad Hadith: Despite not being Mutawatir, Ahad Hadith form the vast majority of the Hadith literature and are crucial for understanding and implementing many aspects of Islamic law and practice. Their authenticity is determined through rigorous Hadith sciences, which examine the reliability of narrators, the continuity of the chain, and the soundness of the text [Page 36].

Examples of Hadith Types (as per the lecture sheet):

- **Mutawatir Hadith:** The lecture sheet mentions the example of the Prophet (SAAS) saying, “Whoever intentionally lies about me, let him take his seat in Hellfire.” This Hadith is narrated by a very large number of companions, making it Mutawatir [Page 36].
- **Ahad Hadith:** Most of the Hadith found in collections like Sahih Bukhari and Sahih Muslim are Ahad, but they are considered authentic due to the rigorous methodology applied by the compilers in verifying their chains and texts [Page 36].

In summary, the classification of Hadith based on the number of reporters is a fundamental aspect of Hadith sciences, enabling scholars to assess their authenticity and reliability, and ensuring that Muslims follow the teachings of the Prophet (SAAS) with confidence. [Page 36]

7. Key Terms in Hadith Sciences (Sp23, Sp24)

This section provides explanations for various key terms and classifications within Hadith sciences, as requested.

As-Sanad (The Chain of Narrators) & Al-Matan (The Text of the Hadith)

In Hadith terminology, every Hadith consists of two main parts: the Sanad and the Matan.

- **As-Sanad (The Chain of Narrators):** The Sanad refers to the chain of narrators who transmitted the Hadith from its source (the Prophet Muhammad SAAS) down to the compiler of the Hadith collection. It lists the names of all individuals in the chain,

starting from the last narrator (the compiler's teacher) and going back to the first narrator (the Companion who heard it directly from the Prophet SAAS). The authenticity and reliability of a Hadith heavily depend on the strength and integrity of its Sanad. Scholars meticulously examine each narrator in the chain for their trustworthiness, memory, and piety [Page 36].

- **Al-Matan (The Text of the Hadith):** The Matan refers to the actual text or wording of the Hadith itself—the statement, action, or description attributed to the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). After establishing the authenticity of the Sanad, Hadith scholars then analyze the Matan to ensure it does not contradict the Qur'an, other authentic Hadith, or established Islamic principles. The Matan is the content of the Hadith, while the Sanad is its pathway [Page 36].

Al-Hadith As-Sahih (Authentic Hadith)

Definition: A Sahih Hadith is a Hadith that meets the highest criteria of authenticity. It is considered sound and reliable, and its content is accepted as genuinely originating from the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). The conditions for a Hadith to be classified as Sahih are stringent [Page 36].

Conditions for a Sahih Hadith:

1. **Connected Chain (Ittisal al-Sanad):** The chain of narration must be continuous, with no missing links. Each narrator must have received the Hadith directly from the one preceding him in the chain.
2. **Just Narrators (Adalah):** All narrators in the chain must be known for their uprightness, piety, and good character. They must be free from major sins and not habitually commit minor sins.
3. **Precise Narrators (Dabt):** All narrators must possess excellent memory and accuracy in transmitting the Hadith. This includes precision in hearing, memorizing, and conveying the text without error.
4. **Free from Irregularity (Shadhdh):** The Hadith must not contradict a more authentic Hadith narrated by a more reliable narrator. If a Hadith from a trustworthy narrator contradicts a stronger narration, it is considered Shadhdh and not Sahih.

5. **Free from Hidden Defects (Illah):** The Hadith must not contain any subtle, hidden defects that might undermine its authenticity, even if it appears sound on the surface. These defects are often discovered through extensive comparison with other narrations [Page 36].

Importance: Sahih Hadith are considered binding in Islamic law and are used as a basis for deriving rulings and understanding Islamic practices. The most famous collections of Sahih Hadith are Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim, which are widely accepted by the Muslim Ummah as the most authentic books after the Qur' an [Page 36].

Al-Hadith Al-Qudsi (Divine Hadith)

Definition: A Hadith Qudsi (Sacred Hadith or Divine Hadith) is a special category of Hadith in which the meaning is from Allah (SWT), but the wording is from the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). It is distinct from the Qur' an (which is both meaning and wording from Allah) and from other Hadith (where both meaning and wording are from the Prophet SAAS) [Page 36].

Characteristics:

- **Divine Meaning, Prophetic Wording:** The core message originates from Allah, but the Prophet (SAAS) conveys it in his own words, often introduced with phrases like “Allah says...” or “The Prophet (SAAS) said, ‘Allah, Exalted is He, says...’ ”
- **Not Part of the Qur' an:** Hadith Qudsi are not part of the Qur' an and are not recited in formal prayers (Salat). Their recitation does not carry the same reward as reciting the Qur' an.
- **Subject Matter:** They often deal with spiritual matters, divine attributes, ethics, and the relationship between Allah and His creation.

Example: A famous Hadith Qudsi states: “Allah says: ‘I am as My servant thinks I am. I am with him when he remembers Me. If he remembers Me in a gathering, I remember him in a gathering better than it. If he draws near to Me a handspan, I draw near to him a cubit. If he draws near to Me a cubit, I draw near to him a fathom. If he comes to Me walking, I come to him running.’ ” [Page 36]

Al-Hadith Al-Mawdu` (Fabricated Hadith)

Definition: A Hadith Mawdu` (Fabricated or Forged Hadith) is a Hadith that is falsely attributed to the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). It is a lie against the Prophet (SAAS) and has no basis in authenticity. Such Hadith are considered the worst type of weak Hadith and are strictly prohibited from being narrated or acted upon once their fabrication is established [Page 36].

Causes of Fabrication: Hadith were fabricated for various reasons, including:

- **Political Motives:** To support a particular political faction or ruler.
- **Sectarianism:** To promote a specific theological or jurisprudential school of thought.
- **Personal Gain:** To gain popularity, wealth, or status.
- **Ignorance/Good Intentions:** Some well-meaning but ignorant individuals fabricated Hadith to encourage good deeds or discourage evil, believing they were serving Islam, unaware of the severe prohibition against lying about the Prophet (SAAS).
- **Enemies of Islam:** To corrupt Islam from within or to discredit the Prophet (SAAS) and his teachings.

Consequences: Narrating a fabricated Hadith knowingly is a major sin, as the Prophet (SAAS) warned: “Whoever narrates a Hadith from me, while he knows it is a lie, then he is one of the liars.” [Page 36]

Six Books of Hadith (Al-Kutub al-Sittah)

The Six Books of Hadith, also known as Al-Kutub al-Sittah, are the most widely accepted and authoritative collections of Hadith in Sunni Islam. These collections were compiled by prominent Hadith scholars centuries after the Prophet’s (SAAS) death, and they represent the culmination of rigorous efforts to authenticate and preserve the Prophetic traditions. These books are:

1. **Sahih al-Bukhari:** Compiled by Imam Muhammad ibn Ismail al-Bukhari (d. 870 CE). It is considered the most authentic book after the Qur’ an and contains approximately 7,563 Hadith with repetitions, and around 2,602 without repetitions. Imam Bukhari spent 16 years compiling it, traveling extensively to gather and verify Hadith. [Page 36]

2. **Sahih Muslim:** Compiled by Imam Muslim ibn al-Hajjaj (d. 875 CE). It is considered the second most authentic book after Sahih al-Bukhari. It contains around 7,190 Hadith with repetitions, and approximately 3,033 without repetitions. Imam Muslim also applied strict criteria for Hadith authenticity. [Page 36]
3. **Sunan Abi Dawud:** Compiled by Imam Abu Dawud Sulayman ibn al-Ash'ath (d. 889 CE). This collection focuses primarily on Hadith related to Islamic law (Fiqh), providing practical guidance on various aspects of worship and daily life. [Page 36]
4. **Jami' al-Tirmidhi:** Compiled by Imam Abu Isa Muhammad ibn Isa al-Tirmidhi (d. 892 CE). This collection is known for its detailed legal discussions and the classification of Hadith into Sahih (authentic), Hasan (good), and Da'if (weak). [Page 36]
5. **Sunan al-Nasa'i:** Compiled by Imam Ahmad ibn Shu'ayb al-Nasa'i (d. 915 CE). This collection also focuses on legal Hadith and is highly regarded for the meticulousness of its compiler. [Page 36]
6. **Sunan Ibn Majah:** Compiled by Imam Muhammad ibn Yazid Ibn Majah (d. 887 CE). While generally considered part of the Kutub al-Sittah, some scholars place it below the other five in terms of authenticity due to the inclusion of a higher number of weaker Hadith. [Page 36]

These six collections serve as the primary reference for Muslims worldwide to understand and practice Islam according to the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS). [Page 36]

Mutawatir Hadith

As explained in the previous section (Question 6), a Mutawatir Hadith is one that has been narrated by such a large number of narrators at each stage of the chain of narration that it is inconceivable for them to have conspired to fabricate a lie. This multitude of narrators ensures its absolute authenticity and reliability, making its content certain and undeniable. The conditions for a Mutawatir Hadith include multiple chains, a large number of narrators at each stage, direct knowledge by the narrators, and consistency in meaning. Examples include the number of daily prayers and the method of performing ablution. [Page 36]

8. The Importance of Asbabun Nuzul (Causes of Revelation) (Sp23)

Definition of Asbabun Nuzul

‘Asbabun Nuzul’ (Causes of Revelation) refers to the specific events, circumstances, or questions that prompted the revelation of particular verses or chapters of the Holy Qur’ an. Knowing these causes provides crucial context for understanding the meaning and application of the revealed text. Imam Wahidi stated that “The verse cannot be an expression without identifying its story and information related to its revelation” [Page 13].

Assessment of the Statement: “Asbabun Nuzul is the best way to know the messages of Holy Qur’ an properly”

The statement that “Asbabun Nuzul is the best way to know the messages of Holy Qur’ an properly” is largely accurate and widely supported by Islamic scholars. Understanding the causes of revelation is indeed paramount for a comprehensive and accurate interpretation of the Qur’ an. Several scholars have emphasized this point:

- **Imam Qushairi** in ‘Al-Burhan Fi-Ulum al-Qur’ an’ stated that “Discussing the ‘Asbabun Nuzul’ is the best way for understanding the meanings of Book of Allah; it is the matter that the followers of Prophet (SAAS) were understood by these symbols and pieces of evidences” [Page 13].
- **Ibn Dakikul Eid** in ‘Al-Itkan’ also affirmed that “Discussing the ‘Asbabun Nuzul’ is the best way to understand the meanings of the Qur’ an” [Page 13].
- **Imam Shaikhul Islam Ibn Taymiyyah** in ‘Usul al-Tafsir’ noted that “Understanding Asbabunnuzul helps us to know the Ayath” [Page 13].
- **Imam Suyooti** in ‘Al-Itkan’ highlighted that one of the benefits of knowing Asbabun Nuzul is “To defend misunderstanding of limitation (Hasar)” [Page 13].

These scholarly opinions underscore that Asbabun Nuzul provides the necessary historical, social, and linguistic context that prevents misinterpretations and allows for a deeper grasp of the Qur’ anic message. Without this context, verses might be misunderstood, misapplied, or their profound wisdom might be overlooked. It helps in distinguishing

between general and specific applications of verses, and in understanding the gradual nature of Islamic legislation.

Various Types of Asbabun Nuzul

Asbabun Nuzul can be broadly categorized based on the nature of the event or question that led to the revelation:

1. **Direct Question or Inquiry:** Many verses were revealed in response to direct questions posed to the Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) by his companions or by non-Muslims. These questions often concerned matters of faith, law, or daily life.
 - **Example:** The verse regarding wine and gambling (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:219) was revealed in response to people asking the Prophet (SAAS) about them. The initial revelation stated that in them is great sin, but also some profit, with the sin being greater than the profit. This was a gradual step towards their complete prohibition [Page 15].
1. **Specific Event or Incident:** Some verses were revealed to address a particular event, dispute, or situation that occurred during the Prophet's (SAAS) time.
 - **Example:** The verses regarding the change of Qiblah (direction of prayer) from Jerusalem to the Ka'bah in Makkah (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:144) were revealed after the Prophet (SAAS) and the Muslims had prayed towards Jerusalem for 17 months after the Hijrah. This revelation came in response to the Prophet's (SAAS) longing for the Qiblah to be the Ka'bah and to differentiate the Muslim Ummah [Page 16].
1. **Clarification of a Misunderstanding or Dispute:** Verses were sometimes revealed to clarify a misunderstanding among the companions or to settle a dispute.
 - **Example:** The lecture sheet discusses the verse about fasting (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:183) and its subsequent clarification (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:184) regarding those who are ill or on a journey, or those who can fast with hardship. Ibn Abbas clarified that the latter verse was not an abrogation but a specification for old men and women who lack the strength to fast, allowing them to feed a poor person instead [Page 17]. This demonstrates how a subsequent revelation can clarify the application of a previous one.

1. **To Address a Specific Act or Behavior:** Some revelations came down to commend or condemn certain actions or behaviors of individuals or groups.
 - **Example:** While not explicitly detailed as an Asbabun Nuzul in the provided text, the verses related to the gradual prohibition of alcohol (Surah An-Nahl 16:67, Surah Al-Baqarah 2:219, Surah An-Nisa 4:43, and Surah Al-Ma'idah 5:90) were revealed in stages to address the deeply ingrained practice of wine drinking in pre-Islamic society. This gradual approach allowed people to adjust to the new prescription [Page 15].

9. Preservation and Compilation of the Holy Qur'an During the Prophet's Time (Sp23, Sp24)

How the Holy Qur'an was Preserved During the Time of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS)

During the lifetime of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS), the Holy Qur'an was preserved through a dual method: memorization and written documentation. This meticulous approach ensured its complete and accurate preservation from the very beginning of its revelation.

1. **Memorization (Hifz):** The primary method of preservation was through memorization. The Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) himself memorized every verse revealed to him. His companions, driven by their deep faith and devotion, also committed the Qur'an to memory. There were a large number of companions who dedicated themselves to memorizing the entire Qur'an, known as Huffaz (memorizers). The Prophet (SAAS) would recite the verses to them, and they would repeat them, ensuring accuracy. This oral tradition was robust, with many companions cross-verifying each other's memorization [Page 19].
2. **Written Documentation:** Alongside memorization, the Qur'an was also meticulously written down. Whenever a verse or a set of verses was revealed, the Prophet (SAAS) would instruct his scribes (Katib al-Wahy) to write them down. These scribes included prominent companions like Zayd ibn Thabit, Ali ibn Abi Talib, Uthman ibn Affan, and others. The verses were written on various available materials, such as palm leaves, flat stones, shoulder blades of animals, and pieces of leather. Although these written

records were scattered and not bound into a single volume, they served as an important physical record of the revelation [Page 19].

Thus, the Qur' an was preserved in the “hearts of men” (memorization) and “on writing materials” during the Prophet' s (SAAS) time [Page 19].

Why the Prophet (SAAS) Did Not Compile the Holy Qur' an in a Single Volume

The Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) did not compile the Holy Qur' an into a single, bound volume during his lifetime for several profound reasons, reflecting the dynamic nature of the revelation and divine wisdom:

1. **Gradual Revelation:** The Qur' an was not revealed all at once but gradually over a period of 23 years. It came down in stages, addressing specific events, questions, and needs of the nascent Muslim community. The revelation continued until shortly before the Prophet' s (SAAS) demise [Page 19].
2. **Abrogation (Naskh):** Some verses were abrogated during the course of the revelation. A later verse might supersede an earlier one in its legal ruling. If the Qur' an had been compiled into a single volume early on, it would have necessitated constant revisions and re-compilations, which could have led to confusion or doubts about its integrity [Page 19].
3. **Flexibility in Arrangement:** The order of the verses and chapters (Surahs) was not always revealed in their final sequence. The Prophet (SAAS) would receive verses and then instruct his companions on where to place them within existing Surahs or as new Surahs. This arrangement was divinely guided and finalized by the Prophet (SAAS) himself, but it required flexibility until the entire revelation was complete [Page 19].
4. **Continuous Revelation:** The revelation continued until the very end of the Prophet' s (SAAS) life. He passed away only nine days after the last revelation. This meant that the complete text of the Qur' an, in its final arrangement, was only finalized at the very end of his mission [Page 19].
5. **Emphasis on Memorization:** The primary emphasis during the Prophet' s (SAAS) time was on memorization, which ensured that the Qur' an was living in the hearts of

thousands of companions. This method provided a robust and immediate means of preservation that was not dependent on physical copies, which were scarce and difficult to produce in large numbers at that time.

When the Holy Qur' an Was Compiled in a Single Volume

The Holy Qur' an was compiled into a single volume (Mushaf) for the first time during the caliphate of **Abu Bakr (ra)**, the first Caliph of Islam. This occurred after the Battle of Yamamah in 11 AH (632 CE), where a large number of companions who had memorized the Qur' an were martyred. Umar ibn al-Khattab (ra), fearing the loss of parts of the Qur' an, urged Abu Bakr (ra) to undertake this monumental task [Page 22].

Abu Bakr (ra) appointed Zayd ibn Thabit (ra), who was a chief scribe of the Prophet (SAAS) and a memorizer of the Qur' an, to lead this compilation effort. Zayd (ra) meticulously collected all the written fragments of the Qur' an from various sources and cross-verified them with the memorized versions of the companions. He accepted no verse unless it was attested to by at least two reliable witnesses. This rigorous process resulted in a single, authenticated manuscript of the entire Qur' an, which remained with Abu Bakr (ra), then Umar (ra), and finally with Hafsa (ra) [Page 22].

Later, during the caliphate of **Uthman ibn Affan (ra)**, the third Caliph, the Qur' an was standardized and multiple copies were made from Abu Bakr' s (ra) original Mushaf. This was done to address the growing discrepancies in recitation among Muslims in different regions of the expanding Islamic empire. Uthman (ra) again appointed Zayd ibn Thabit (ra) to lead a committee to produce these standardized copies, which were then distributed to major Muslim centers, and all other variant copies were destroyed to ensure uniformity [Page 23].

Therefore, while the initial compilation into a single volume occurred under Abu Bakr (ra), the standardization and widespread dissemination of the Qur' an in its final, unified form happened under Uthman (ra). Both stages were crucial for the immaculate preservation of the Holy Qur' an. [Page 19, 22, 23]